



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

PATIENT BALANCES & REVENUE-CYCLE RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Receivables Recovery for Dermatology Practices

Recovering aged patient balances across three locations — payment plans, dispute handling and third-party recovery on pure contingency

Prepared for **Better Skin Dermatology** · August 2026

A recovery partner for the balances that outlast your billing cycle

To Julie and the Better Skin Dermatology billing team — thank you for reaching out. Running billing across Scottsdale, Carefree and Maricopa means the same balance can age quietly in three places at once, and a practice mixing medical, surgical and cosmetic work carries three different kinds of patient responsibility on one ledger.

You asked about three things — payment plans, third-party collections and dispute handling. That combination tells us the problem is not one stubborn account; it is capacity. A billing team sized for claims cannot also run structured follow-up on hundreds of aged patient balances.

Southwest Recovery Services is an outsourced receivables recovery partner working healthcare and patient balances on **pure contingency since 2004**. You place through a secure portal that takes your practice-management export, and we work them. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of healthcare recovery — nationwide

A documented, compliant process and a real dermatology track record — follow-up capacity across all three locations without adding headcount to the billing office.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

The three things you asked about

Payment plans, third-party collections and dispute handling, in that order, plus what your 61–90 and 90+ aging means in practice.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Payment plans	We set up and administer structured arrangements directly with the patient, monitor them, and restart follow-up the moment one is missed — the administrative burden that makes plans unworkable for an in-house team. Many patients who ignore a statement will agree to \$50 a month when someone actually asks.
2. Third-party collections	Aged balances worked through compliant multi-channel outreach, with skip tracing where a patient has moved or changed numbers. Reportable balances go to Equifax and Experian.
3. Dispute handling	A dispute pauses recovery, it does not end it. We validate against the paper — the ledger, the EOB, the signed financial policy, the treatment record — and speak with both sides. In dermatology, cosmetic versus medically-necessary is the usual root of it, and the documentation settles it.
Your aging — the honest read	You listed 61–90 and 90+. A book weighted to 90+ behaves like the lower end of the case studies below, not the top. We would rather set that expectation now than quote you an average you will not see. The fresher 61–90 tranche is where most of the early recovery will come from.
Three locations, one ledger	Place from all three sites through one portal with location-level reporting, so Scottsdale, Carefree and Maricopa can be tracked separately without three separate processes.

**THE SWRS CLIENT
PORTAL**

Practice-management-ready intake across every location

Every placement runs through our secure portal — built to take your practice-management export and give the billing team live, self-service access.

AGING-EXPORT PLACEMENT

Upload straight from your PM system — we map your columns, no re-keying, and location stays as a field so reporting splits cleanly.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send EOBs, ledgers, signed financial policies and treatment records safely inside the portal — the documentation that resolves a dispute.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand, by location or across the practice.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments taken at any front desk, so balances stay accurate and no patient is contacted after paying.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Dermatology Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's dermatology book, anonymized. The spread runs from 45% down to 15%, and that range is the point: the practices at the bottom placed old books, the ones at the top placed early. With a 90+ weighting, plan around the lower half of this range.

DERMATOLOGY PRACTICE

Metro practice, TX

\$31.0K recovered

of ~\$69K placed

45% recovered

DERMATOLOGY & LASER

Aesthetic-led practice

\$7.2K recovered

of ~\$21K placed

34% recovered

DERM & PLASTIC SURGERY

GROUP

Multi-provider group

\$36.0K recovered

of ~\$120K placed

30% recovered

DERMATOLOGY PRACTICE

Suburban single site

\$8.7K recovered

of ~\$31K placed

28% recovered

DERMATOLOGY PRACTICE

Regional practice

\$11.7K recovered

of ~\$51K placed

23% recovered

DERMATOLOGY GROUP —

AGED BOOK

Multi-site, 90+ weighted

\$160.0K recovered

of ~\$1.04M placed

15% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

**WHAT THE SPREAD ACTUALLY
MEASURES**

Age at placement, not effort, explains the difference

The 45% and the 15% above were worked by the same people using the same process. The difference is when the balance arrived. A patient balance placed at 90 days still has a working phone number and a recent memory of the visit; the same balance at two years has neither.

THE AGE CURVE

Recovery falls steeply with age — which is why the 61–90 portion of your book is worth placing first and fastest.

THE STANDING RULE

A fixed policy of placing at 90 days recovers materially more than case-by-case decisions, and on contingency there is no cost to placing.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked.

We speak your ledger

Medical, surgical and cosmetic work on one ledger creates a specific recovery profile. Our playbook is built for that mix.



Medical vs. cosmetic balances

Cosmetic work is self-pay by definition and behaves differently from a post-insurance medical balance — we work them as the different arguments they are.



Post-Mohs and surgical balances

Larger balances after surgical dermatology, where a structured payment plan usually recovers more than pressure.



Insurance follow-up

Underpaid, denied and never-worked claims chased on the payer side, so a patient is not pursued for money an insurer owes.



Three locations, one process

Placement, reporting and reconciliation across Scottsdale, Carefree and Maricopa without three separate workflows.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that returns more of each aging balance and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. He became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

A patient with an aged balance is often still a patient — skin cancer screening brings people back yearly. Recovery has to stay professional and documented so the relationship survives the conversation.

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Better Skin Dermatology

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Patient Balances & Healthcare Receivables

Healthcare · PDF

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The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

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The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

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The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

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The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's put a number against your aged patient balances.

A 30-minute call with Hunter Howard to walk your 61–90 and 90+ aging, agree how payment plans and disputes are handled, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for Better Skin Dermatology. FDCPA / CFPB / FCRA compliant · ACA International member.